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Focus

I want to help state and local governments build the capacity to withstand a misaligned AI incident before one happens, not after. Little to no work has been done on security capacity below the national level, and when, not if, a misaligned agent causes real harm, our state and local governments will be in a reactive mode. My approach draws on war gaming and civic education: crisis simulations and tabletop exercises that move civic leaders and government officials past abstraction and towards concrete, practical thinking about the future, while bringing more people into the tent of AI safety.

Target roles

I'm still exploring, but the opportunities I find most compelling sit at the intersection of crisis simulation and AI governance:

- Designing and facilitating AI crisis simulations and tabletop exercises for state, county, and local governments
- Exercise design or research roles at organizations already doing this work (e.g., RAND, the Center for AI Policy, the Brennan Center)
- Civic engagement and coalition building around AI preparedness, especially nonpartisan and bipartisan efforts

Experience

- **War gaming and simulation.** I've participated in war gaming and simulation exercises and have conducted them for students in a national security capacity. These experiences taught me that during a crisis, you will default to your lowest level of training, and that the real value of a simulation is the postmortem or After Action Report.
- **Education and civic discourse.** I work in the education space, with a focus on the need for nonpartisan and bipartisan approaches to coalition building and civic discourse.
- **Simulation design for AI risk.** I developed a plan for a crisis simulation that tests the assumptions state and local officials have about their capacity to mitigate harm from a misaligned AI incident. The design uses an identical scenario across teams with different levels of hypothetical capacity, mixes participants across party lines and civic roles (e.g., pairing a city council member with a local church leader), and follows the exercise with a reception and a second event to build lasting relationships among participants.

Engagement with AI safety/Biosecurity

- **BlueDot Impact:** AGI Strategy, 2026. Final project: *Security Capacity Buildout: Simulation Exercises*, a strategic assessment, theory of change, and learning plan for AI crisis simulations at the state and local level.
- **Self-directed study:** FEMA's Homeland Security Exercise and Evaluation Program (HSEEP), CISA Tabletop Exercise Packages, the Center for Internet Security white paper on generative AI for tabletop exercises, and existing AI crisis exercises (RAND Europe, CISA/JCDC, Brennan Center and the Arizona Secretary of State).
- **Upcoming commitments:**
  1. Learn how to design simulations for a variety of constraints (an afternoon, a weekend, a week; different scopes of crisis)
  2. Research who has already conducted similar events
  3. Write a draft simulation and proposal, then pilot it with a single city or county